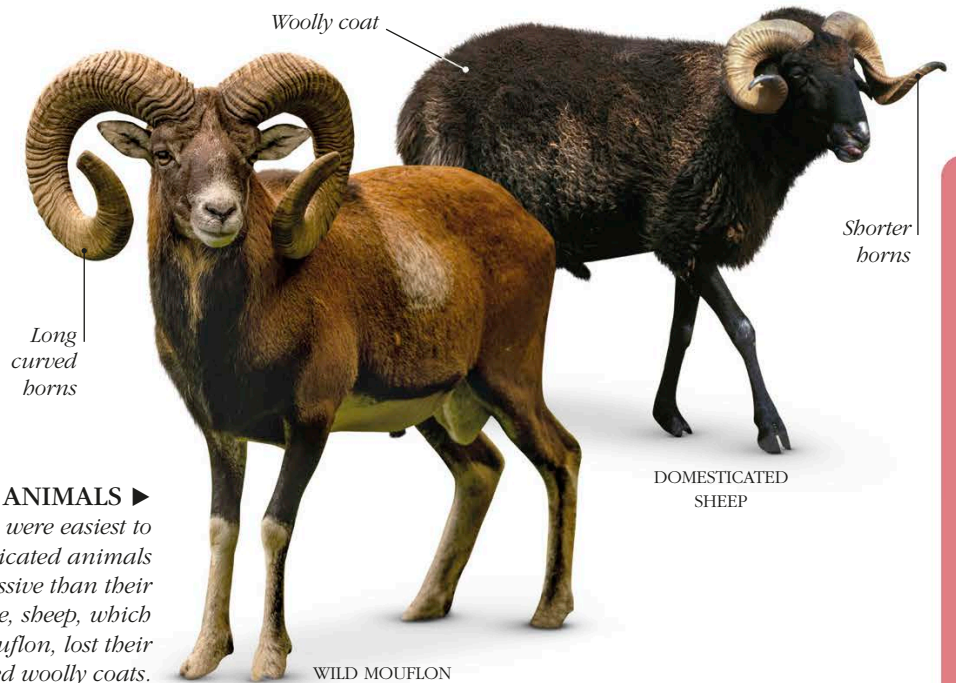


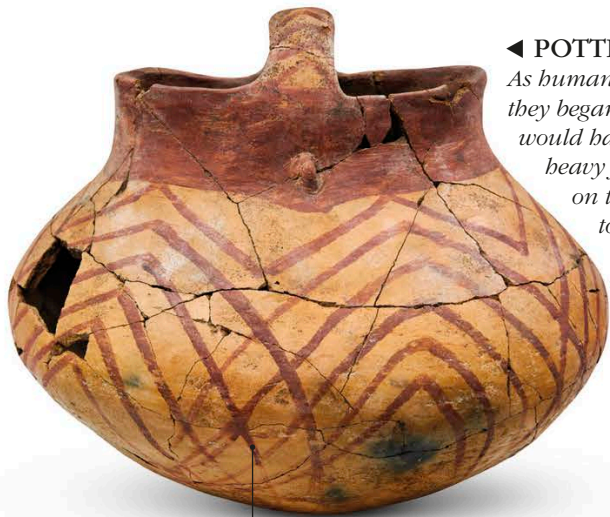
FACT

The wild ancestors of the main domesticated animals are the mouflon (sheep), bezoar ibex (goat), wild boar (pig), aurochs (cattle), and the South Asian jungle fowl (chicken).



DOMESTICATING ANIMALS ►

Early farmers bred animals that were easiest to control. As a result, domesticated animals grew smaller and less aggressive than their wild ancestors. For example, sheep, which were domesticated from the mouflon, lost their long horns and developed woolly coats.

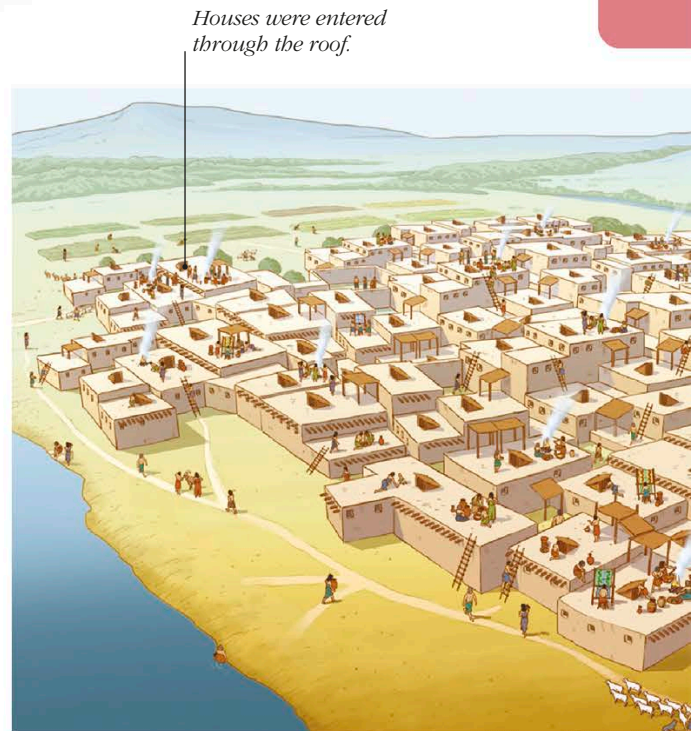


◀ POTTERY

As humans settled in one place, they began to make pottery, which would have been fragile and heavy for hunter-gatherers on the move. Pottery led to changes in the human diet, allowing people to bake bread, make cheese, and boil meat for stews. It was both decorative and useful.

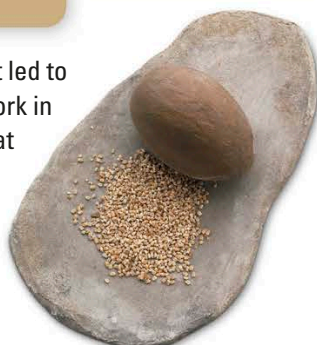
FIRST TOWN ►

As populations grew, people began to live in dense settlements. Çatalhöyük, dating from 7400–6200 BCE, is one of the world's oldest known towns. It was home to several thousand people who lived in rectangular houses packed together to save space.



EVERYDAY LIFE

When people began to farm, it led to a gradual division between work in the fields and domestic work at home. Women usually took up the responsibilities at home, spending long hours making clothes or grinding grain on a quern (right) to make bread.



ANCESTOR WORSHIP ►

In the early towns, such as Çatalhöyük and Jericho (in modern-day Palestine), the dead were buried beneath the floors of the houses as a way to remember them. In Jericho, the skulls of ancestors were preserved and given new features, modeled in clay with eyes made of shells.

